

Creamy White Bean Soup

This light, creamy white bean soup recipe is richly flavored thanks to plenty of beans, veggies and Parmesan cheese.

By **Alex Loh** | Updated on September 23, 2025

✓ Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 25 mins

Total Time: 45 mins

Servings: 6

Nutrition Profile:

No Added Sugar Gut Healthy Sesame-Free Weight Loss Nut-Free Healthy Pregnancy Soy-Free High-Fiber
Healthy Cholesterol Vegetarian Egg-Free Gluten-Free

Ingredients

- 2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 medium yellow onion, chopped
- 2 medium stalks celery, chopped
- 1 tablespoon minced garlic
- 1 tablespoon Italian seasoning
- ¼ teaspoon crushed red pepper
- 2 (15-ounce) cans no-salt-added great northern beans, rinsed
- 1 (2 ounce) Parmesan cheese rind (optional)
- 4 cups unsalted vegetable broth
- ¾ teaspoon salt
- ½ teaspoon ground pepper
- 1 fresh *or* dried bay leaf
- ½ teaspoon grated lemon zest
- 2 teaspoons lemon juice
- ¼ cup grated Parmesan cheese
- 1 tablespoon chopped fresh flat-leaf parsley for garnish (optional)

Directions

Step 1

Heat 2 tablespoons oil in a large pot over medium-high heat. Add chopped onion and chopped celery; cook, stirring often, until the onion is translucent, about 5 minutes. Add 1 tablespoon garlic, 1 tablespoon Italian seasoning and ¼ teaspoon crushed red pepper; cook, stirring occasionally, until aromatic, about 2 minutes. Stir in 30 ounces rinsed beans, 2-ounce Parmesan rind (if using), 4 cups broth, ¾ teaspoon salt, ½ teaspoon pepper and 1 bay leaf; bring to a boil over high heat. Reduce heat to medium-low and cook, stirring occasionally, until the vegetables are tender, about 20 minutes. Remove and discard the Parmesan rind (if using) and bay leaf.

Step 2

Pour 2 cups of the soup into a blender. Secure the lid on the blender and remove the center piece to allow steam to escape. Place a clean towel over the opening. Process until smooth, about 1 minute. (Use caution when blending hot liquids. Alternatively, pour 2 cups of the soup into a medium bowl; process until smooth using an immersion blender.)

Step 3

Pour the pureed soup back into the remaining soup in the pot; stir to combine. Stir in ½ teaspoon lemon zest and 2 teaspoons lemon juice. Divide the soup among 4 bowls; sprinkle with ¼ cup Parmesan. Garnish with 1 tablespoon parsley, if desired.

Recipe Updates

Based on earlier review and comments of this recipe, we've retested and made the following adjustments (and updated the nutritional analysis accordingly):

Decreased celery and crushed red pepper (to improve flavor).

Increased salt and Parmesan cheese (to boost flavor).

Updated May 2025

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I use dried beans instead of canned?



Absolutely. The rule of thumb is that for every 15 ounces of canned beans in a recipe, you'll want to cook 1½ cups of dried beans, so you're looking at 3 cups dried for this recipe. Be sure to plan ahead, allowing time for soaking, which is essential for the beans to cook evenly and to reduce the cooking time significantly.

How should I store and reheat the soup?



It's best to store soup the refrigerator in an airtight container where it will last for about 3 days. To reheat, you can microwave it on medium until warm or on the stovetop over medium-low heat. Make sure it doesn't boil.

Can I freeze the soup?

Since this soup doesn't contain cream, it freezes well, if you leave out the garnish. Portion the soup into individual freezer-safe containers and freeze. Thaw the soup overnight in the refrigerator, and gently warm it in the microwave or on the stovetop.

What should I serve with Creamy White Bean Soup?

A bowl of this soup pairs perfectly with some crusty bread or skillet cornbread. If you're serving the soup in a small mug, consider adding a sandwich, such as our Baked Falafel Sandwiches, Cucumber & Roasted Red Pepper Hummus Wrap or Cucumber & Tomato Sandwich. For salads, we recommend our Marinated Cucumber & Tomato Salad, Kale Salad with Cranberries or our Simplest Spinach Salad.

Recipe developed by Jasmine Smith

EatingWell.com, January 2022

Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 1 cup** 186 calories; total fat 6g; saturated fat 1g; cholesterol 4mg; sodium 454mg ; total carbohydrate 25g; dietary fiber 7g; total sugars 2g; added sugars 0g; protein 9g; vitamin c 6mg; calcium 127mg; iron 2mg; potassium 511mg

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S. and Linda Frahm

*Additional reporting by **Carrie Myers, M.S. and Linda Frahm***

Explore more:

[Healthy Recipes](#)[Soup](#)[Bean Soup](#)

Was this page helpful?



